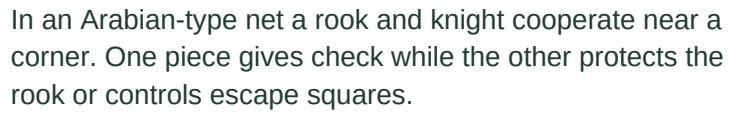


Arabian mating nets

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Look for a cornered king, a rook entry, and a knight square that links protection with restriction.

The defending king is on a1. Geometrically undefended: knight on h5 and knight on e5. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 29.Nh5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

29...Ra3+ 30. bxa3 Rxb1#

29...Ra3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **30.bxa3**.

30...Rxb1# Mate: rook on b1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on b1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A mating label describes a recurring arrangement, not a substitute for checking the exact legal defenses on this board.